analysis of the relationship between the decline of Humanism and the rise of Fascism. He agrees that today 'there is unmistakably a deep cultural crisis in our society. We no longer know what our common spiritual values are…'[230] Furthermore, 'our society is a kitsch society because it disregards the highest good, spiritual values, and we live our entire existence under the emblem of pleasure. […] Because there are no longer any absolute spiritual values, there is no objective measure for our actions, and everything becomes subjective.'[231] But contrary to most social conservatives, he believes that 'a far greater threat to our society than Islamic fundamentalism is the crisis inherent in mass society: the moral crisis, the ever increasing trivialisation and dumbing-down of our society'. He rightly warns the advocates of Christian values that 'the defender of Judeo-Christian and humanistic traditions will always believe in a universal ethics that includes all people'[232] and strongly believes that the PVV party, mentioned earlier in relation to my Dutch experience, 'is the shameless opposite of the Judeo-Christian and humanist traditions'.[233] He would also have this to say to social conservatives and (Christian) fundamentalists in Eastern Europe and elsewhere: 'People are left high and dry by conservative intellectuals who simply cannot understand that precisely because truth is absolute, we always have to be prepared for the changing shapes of truth through different periods, and that to be faithful to truth and to live in truth, we have to look out for the new, for change.'[234] He warns against populism as the 'kitsch culture of the mass-man', which, if coupled with nationalism, turns into fascism.[235] But it is, above all, 'the spiritual vacuum in which fascism can grow large again'[236] – something many Christians would certainly agree with.

As would, probably, Charles Taylor, Canadian philosopher and author of the famous book *A Secular Age*, 'the most important work about religion in our times',[237] who also expresses concerns about the departure of European civilisation from its Humanistic roots: 'Their denigration by modern humanism, in the name of equality, happiness and an end to suffering, was what was degrading the human being, reducing human life to something no longer worth living, spreading "nihilism". In our day, this attack against civilising humanism has been taken up by Michel Foucault. […] This was the (not really explicit) ethical meaning behind the much trumpeted "end of man"; as it is the point of the denunciation of "humanism" among many